

Mav and the Def Leppard Deduction

Maverick stood on his front porch, pointing a trembling finger at the street where **Taffy Stamburger** and **Cheap Whiskey** were currently drag-racing their gold-spoke bicycles while their neon frosted tips glowed in the sun.

"Professor," Mav said, looking down at the Bucktooth doll. "They are wearing floor-length leopard-print pimp coats. They have gold bikes. Yesterday I dreamed I won ten billion dollars and a living version of you pickpocketed me. Care to explain the structural coincidence?"

The Bucktooth doll stared forward with unblinking button eyes. "Maverick! The atmosphere is currently experiencing a 40% increase in 'unexplained luxury'! It is a foundational mystery! Perhaps they found a very lucrative vein of recycled aluminum? Or maybe they are just living their best, most fashion-forward lives! Toodaloo to the questions, we have a sonic emergency!"

"A sonic emergency?"

"There is a melody trapped in my felt cranium, Maverick! It is vibrating against my stuffing! We must go to the **Guitar Center** and find its source before my internal logic-circuits melt like a cheap Gouda!"

They made their way to the Clovis Guitar Center. The air inside was a cacophony of amateur musicians. In one corner, a kid was playing the riff to *Seven Nation Army* for the 400th time. In another, a guy was struggling through *Enter Sandman*, while a third was butchering *Crazy Train*.

"You're never going to find your song in here, Professor," Mav sighed. "It sounds like a construction site for a haunted house."

"Silence, Splinter! I have a method!" Bucktooth squeaked.

The doll suddenly leaped from Mav's arms. He scuttled over to a display, grabbed a **sharpened crash cymbal**, and hovered menacingly toward a teenager playing a dusty Stratocaster.

"CITIZEN!" the doll shrieked. "Play the song that is currently resonating in my whiskers! If the frequency is incorrect, there will be structural consequences for your hairstyle!"

"I... I only know the intro to *Smoke on the Water*!" the teenager stammered.

"INCORRECT!" Bucktooth roared. He swung the sharpened cymbal and sliced a festive pinata that was mysteriously hanging from the ceiling. A tidal wave of **thick maple syrup** exploded downward, coating the teenager from head to toe.

"MY GEAR! MY FLANNEL!" the kid screamed, running out of the store like a sticky ghost.

Mav tried to grab the doll, but Bucktooth was on a manic roll. He waddled over to a man in his 30s who was tuning an acoustic guitar. "YOU! Play the anthem of my soul!"

"I only play the hits of the **Bee Gees**," the man said smugly. "I'm a disco purist."

"Oh, you like the Bee Gees?" Bucktooth hissed, his button eyes gleaming with madness. "Then you shall experience the **BEE-GEES** in their primary form!"

The Professor reached into his tiny plush pocket and pulled out a jar labeled '**AGGRESSIVE HONEY BEES - DO NOT SHAKE.**' He shattered it against the man's back. Within seconds, the guitarist was a living swarm.

"THEY'RE IN MY POCKETS! STAYIN' ALIVE! STAYIN' ALIVE!" the man yelled, sprinting through the glass doors.

Bucktooth turned toward Maverick, spinning the cymbal like a buzzsaw. He was vibrating. "THE SONG, MAVERICK! THE MELODY IS A CAGE! WHY CAN'T YOU HEAR THE VIBRATIONS?!"

"Professor, calm down!" Mav yelled, backing away. "You're going crazy! Put down the cymbal! This will all **pour over** and we'll be okay!"

The Professor froze. His whiskers twitched. "Pour over? Pour what exactly, Maverick? Are you suggesting a foundational liquid transfer? A structural overflow of syrup?"

"No! I mean... it'll pass! It'll pour over!"

Bucktooth dropped the cymbal. A look of profound clarity washed over his felt face. "Pour... over... pour some... **POUR SOME SUGAR ON ME!**"

The Professor suddenly began to headbang with such force that his beret flew off. "AHA! DEF LEPPARD! THE ARCHITECTS OF HAIR-METAL! THE SONG IS FOUND! I am now as cool as a cucumber, Maverick! My internal structural balance has been restored!"

"Great," Mav panted, looking at the syrup-covered floor and the lingering bees. "Can we go now?"

"Yes! But first, I have a hunger that can only be satisfied by a **Meat Mountain!** We must go to Arby's and pay tribute to Sir Flopsy-Steak!"

Just then, a horn honked outside. The leopard-print pimp coats of **Taffy Stamburger** and **Cheap Whiskey** flashed in the window. They were leaning out of a gold-plated SUV (which had somehow replaced the bikes in the last five minutes).

"Yo, monkes!" Taffy yelled, his frosted tips shimmering. "Need a ride to the meats? We're treating! We found a pile of cash in a 'super secret box' that definitely didn't belong to anyone

else!"

Mav hopped in the back seat. Bucktooth climbed onto the dashboard, giving Taffy a **long, cold, suspicious stare** that suggested the Professor knew exactly where the ten billion dollars had gone. Taffy just winked at the camera and popped a wheelie in an SUV, which shouldn't be physically possible.

"Darn tootin'," Cheap Whiskey muttered, biting into a virtual taco.

"Toodaloo," the doll whispered, still staring at Taffy. "The meats... they are calling."